

Robbery

Mobile-device examination and investigative reporting

Troy Hokanson

Sanitized case study. Adapted from my forensic examination report and corroborated by my case log. Names, dates, locations and device/account identifiers are omitted. This is a newly written summary, not an original agency document.

Assignment and my role

I examined mobile devices submitted in a robbery investigation with a search warrant, examination request and police report. I documented device condition, used a radio-frequency shielding enclosure during device handling, and performed supported extractions using Cellebrite UFED and GrayKey. The report distinguished successful extractions, partial access and an unsupported device.

Finding 1: Useful evidence despite a locked phone

An unknown passcode prevented full access to one phone. I obtained partial file-system and backup extractions with GrayKey and a separate SIM-card extraction with Cellebrite UFED. The available data included account records, contacts, logs and media. This provided material for investigator review while preserving an important limit: the examination did not recover all data from the device.

Finding 2: Consistency between device and SIM records

I identified a last-used phone number and its associated SIM identifier in the extracted device data. The SIM identifier matched the card inside the phone. Other number and SIM associations were also documented. This gave investigators records to compare with other evidence; those associations alone did not establish who possessed or used the phone at a particular time.

Finding 3: Activity around relevant dates

I bookmarked device log entries and power events around dates relevant to the investigation, along with images and videos of potential investigative interest. These selections focused investigator review on potentially relevant activity. Power events alone did not place the phone at a crime scene or establish who operated it.

Limits and report

Results varied across the submitted devices. One was unsupported by the extraction tool at the time; another yielded no material assessed as valuable to the investigation. I documented these results alongside the successful and partial extractions.

I generated bookmarked reports and specified report media for investigator review and retention. My contribution was the forensic examination, identification of potentially relevant artifacts and clear documentation of access limits. No arrest, conviction or other case outcome is claimed in this sample.